Ten-Frame Builder

TEACHER KEY

1st Grade Math · Interactive Math · Explore & Reflect

Get started

Fill two ten-frames with red and yellow counters to add, take away and make ten. The number sentence changes as you build. Open the tool and use it to answer each question.

Explore

1. Show 7 + 3. How many empty boxes are in the first ten-frame?

0 — it is full. 7 + 3 = 10

2. Show 9 + 4. Write it as 10 + __.

10 + 3 = 13

3. Show 8 + 5. How many yellow counters fill the first frame? How many are in the second frame?

2 fill the first frame; 3 are in the second. 8 + 5 = 13

4. Show 5 + 6, then 6 + 5. Are the totals the same?

Yes. Both are 11.

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Explore more

5. Make 14. Take away 6. How many are left?

8 (14 − 6 = 8)

6. Write two different ways to make 10 with red and yellow counters.

Any two pairs that make 10, for example 4 + 6 and 7 + 3

Reflect

7. Reflect: How does a ten-frame help you add 8 + 6?

Move 2 of the 6 to fill the frame: 10 + 4 = 14.

Teacher notes

- Start with partners of 10: keep red + yellow = 10 and ask students to find every pair.
- For make-ten facts (8 + 5, 9 + 4), ask: How many yellow counters will fill the first frame? How many are left over?
- Use Take away for take-from stories: “There were 12 birds. 4 flew away.” Students build 12 and cross out 4.

Standards: 1.OA.A.1, 1.OA.C.5, 1.OA.C.6. Accept any correct answer where several are possible, and ask students to explain with the tool’s picture.